

SOMETHING MISSING

The defending champion Celtics' dream of repeating came crashing down Friday night, as they were dominated most of the way by New York in Game 6 and dropped the Eastern Conference semifinals, 4 games to 2. Boston had stayed alive by taking Game 5 at home without injured Jayson Tatum, but had no chance at Madison Square Garden. **C1.**



DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

Hundreds of grants ended at Harvard

Notices put long-running studies on cancer, other diseases at grave risk

By Chris Serres and Kay Lazar
GLOBE STAFF

In yet another escalation of its fight against higher education, the Trump administration has moved to terminate hundreds of research grants at Harvard University and its medical school, imperiling dozens of research projects and potentially upending the futures of young scientists.

Harvard researchers studying cancer, infectious diseases, and other topics began receiving termination notices for tens of millions of dollars in research funding en masse Thursday from multiple federal agencies, including the National Institutes of Health, National Science Foundation, and the US departments of Defense and Energy, according to emails shared with the Globe.

“The scale of what happened is incomprehensible — a bloodbath for research and the wider community,” said Brittany Charlton, associate professor at the Harvard T.H. Chan School of Public Health and founding director of the LGBTQ Health Center of Excellence, whose federal funding was terminated in March. “Entire labs are unraveling, and young scientists on training grants may be suddenly adrift. Work that could change lives — or save them — is being brought to a standstill.”

HARVARD, Page A7

Citing deficit, conservatives block megabill

GOP defections highlight complicated path ahead

By Catie Edmondson
NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — Conservatives on the House Budget Committee on Friday blocked their party's megabill from reaching the floor, citing concerns that the legislation to fulfill President Trump's domestic agenda would add too much to the deficit.

It was a remarkable revolt that threatened to upend the party's goal of pushing the legislation through the House before its Memorial Day recess and sent Republican leaders scrambling to try to put down the uprising.

The setback underscored the treacherous balancing act that Speaker Mike Johnson is trying to pull off. Without the support of Republican hardliners on the Budget Committee, the bill cannot advance. But any changes to win their backing could alienate the more moderate Republicans whose votes will also be needed to pass the measure on the House floor.

Five Republican representatives — Chip Roy of Texas, Ralph Norman of South Carolina, Josh Brecheen of Oklahoma, Andrew Clyde of Georgia, and Lloyd Smucker of Pennsylvania — joined Democrats in voting to block the legislation. The vote

CONGRESS, Page A7

In 1940, there were fewer than 10 black bears present in Massachusetts. **Today, there are nearly 5,000.**

Surging bear population prompts state to expand hunting season

By Erin Douglas
GLOBE STAFF

The population of black bears in Massachusetts is on the rise, and state regulators see that as a big problem.

More bears mean more humans interacting with bears. It means more bears in backyards, more bears in heavily populated Eastern Massachusetts, and, of course, more calls complaining about bears.

To cull the population growth, the Massachusetts Fisheries and Wildlife Board voted this week in favor of new regulations to expand the bear hunting season.

“[Bears] will become established in Eastern Massachusetts if we don't increase the harvest from our hunting seasons,” black bear state biologist Dave Wattles warned the board on Wednesday. Shortly after his presentation, the board voted for the expanded season.

If the rules are adopted by the governor's office, the bear hunting season will be extended by more than a month, and the state will create youth bear hunting permits. Currently, bears may be hunted only during three different periods in the fall: about three weeks in September, three weeks in November, and during the shotgun deer season, which is typically in early December. Youth ages 12 to 17 may hunt bears only by using an adult's permit, meaning that the adult may not also kill a bear that year if the



COHASSET POLICE DEPARTMENT

As the black bear population grows, there are more human and bear interactions and more bears in backyards.

youth they are supervising does.

Under the new regulations, bear hunting would be allowed continuously from Labor Day through early December. That means hunters could kill bears throughout October, which was previously off-limits. State officials expect the regulations to take effect in 2026.

Black bears were once almost eliminated from the Commonwealth due to deforestation. They've made a dramatic comeback: Currently, there are around 4,500 black bears in Massa-

BEARS, Page A10

Maine's lobstermen brace for trade war

Tariffs, possible recession: 'It's just a nightmare'

By Sam Brodey
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — Maine's hardy lobster fishery has, seemingly, seen it all.

Good seasons and bad. The ups and downs of government regulations. The growing threat of warming seas.

But this year, the state's thousands of lobstermen, and the thousands more whose livelihoods depend on the industry, are staring down a storm the likes they've never seen before.

As President Trump wages an unprecedented protectionist campaign to impose or tease steep tariffs on nearly every trading partner, an industry that thrives on the free flow of global trade — and disposable cash in Americans' wallets — could suffer disproportionately.

“I'm extremely worried,” said Dave Cousens, a former president of the Maine Lobster-

LOBSTERS, Page A6

Food order delivers a connection

Woman enlists others to help retired teacher who inspired her

Retired high school teacher Wilmer Melendez was working as a DoorDash deliverer when his former student Lorainy Peñaló received an order from him.



LORAINY PEÑALÓ

By Claire Thornton
GLOBE STAFF

Lorainy Peñaló, a physician assistant in Springfield, was enjoying a cold January night at home with hot and tasty Dominican takeout incoming.

Reaching for her order of chicken, tostones, and arroz con gandules, Peñaló recognized a familiar face — one that had inspired her as a high school student to study science and eventually pursue a career in medicine.

The delivery man standing in her apartment lobby was 69-year-old Wilmer Melendez, a retired Springfield Central High School chemistry teacher. He was hustling for DoorDash because he and his wife, another

retired teacher, needed to pay for credit card debt, emergency home repairs, and their son's college education.

When Peñaló learned Melendez, who has a chronic autoimmune disorder, needed financial help, she posted about their encounter on social media. Her classmates from Springfield Central's class of 2010 quickly took notice and launched a GoFundMe page supporting Melendez and his wife, Lissette, 63.

In about one week, the community raised more than \$41,000. Peñaló said she wasn't expecting to raise nearly that much and was floored by the response.

“I thought, if we get to \$300 I'd be

TEACHER, Page A10

The Trump administration will not be allowed to deport a group of Venezuelans under a rarely invoked wartime law while the matter is litigated, the Supreme Court said. **A2.**

Direct peace talks between Ukrainian and Russian negotiators took place for the first time since the start of the war, resulting in an agreement for what would be the largest prisoner swap of the conflict. **A4.**

The Emerald Necklace Conservancy is going back to court to block the renovation of White Stadium, and the City of Boston and its new professional women's soccer team are not happy about it. **B1.**

The state's unemployment rate rose to 4.6 percent in April, the fourth straight increase. **D1.**



Pair of bloomers

Saturday: Stormy afternoon. High: 68-73. Low: 58-63.

Sunday: Breezy, less humid. High: 69-74. Low: 54-59.

Comics and Weather, **D4-5.** Obituaries, **C10.**

VOL. 307, NO. 137

Suggested retail price \$4.00

